Salary Management Tool

Clarifying questions and working assumptions

To make sure the tool fits how ACME's HR team works today, it would help to confirm a few points with the client. Short answers are perfectly fine. Development is already under way on the assumptions listed at the end, and the answers will refine it.

Questions

1 What pay questions does HR get asked most often, and by whom?

For example: average salary by country, how one role is paid in different countries, who is paid far more or less than others, or total payroll cost.

Why this matters: The reports will answer the questions the team really gets, not a generic set.

2 What does one employee row look like today?

Which columns are in the current spreadsheet? A few sample rows with names removed would help a lot.

Why this matters: The tool will use the same columns, so nothing the team needs is lost.

3 Who will use the tool?

Is it only the HR manager, or will others also view or edit salaries? Should some people see only part of the data, like a manager seeing only their own country?

Why this matters: This decides if the tool needs logins and different access levels.

4 Should currency conversion use fixed rates or live rates?

Fixed rates are set once, for example at each pay review, so numbers stay the same. Live rates follow the market, so numbers change every day.

Why this matters: This decides if comparisons between countries stay steady or follow today's rates.

5 When a salary changes, is the old salary needed later?

For example, to see an employee's past raises, or what pay looked like at last year's review.

Why this matters: This decides if the tool keeps every past salary or only the current one.

Working assumptions

Please flag any of these that do not hold for ACME.

- **Currency:** Each salary is stored in the employee's local currency. For comparisons between countries, salaries are converted to one currency (USD), so no one has to convert them by hand.
- **Leavers:** Employees who leave are archived, not deleted. Their records are kept, but they do not appear in reports.
- **Moving off Excel:** The current spreadsheet can be uploaded as a CSV file, and any rows with problems are clearly marked. Data can also be downloaded as a CSV file at any time.